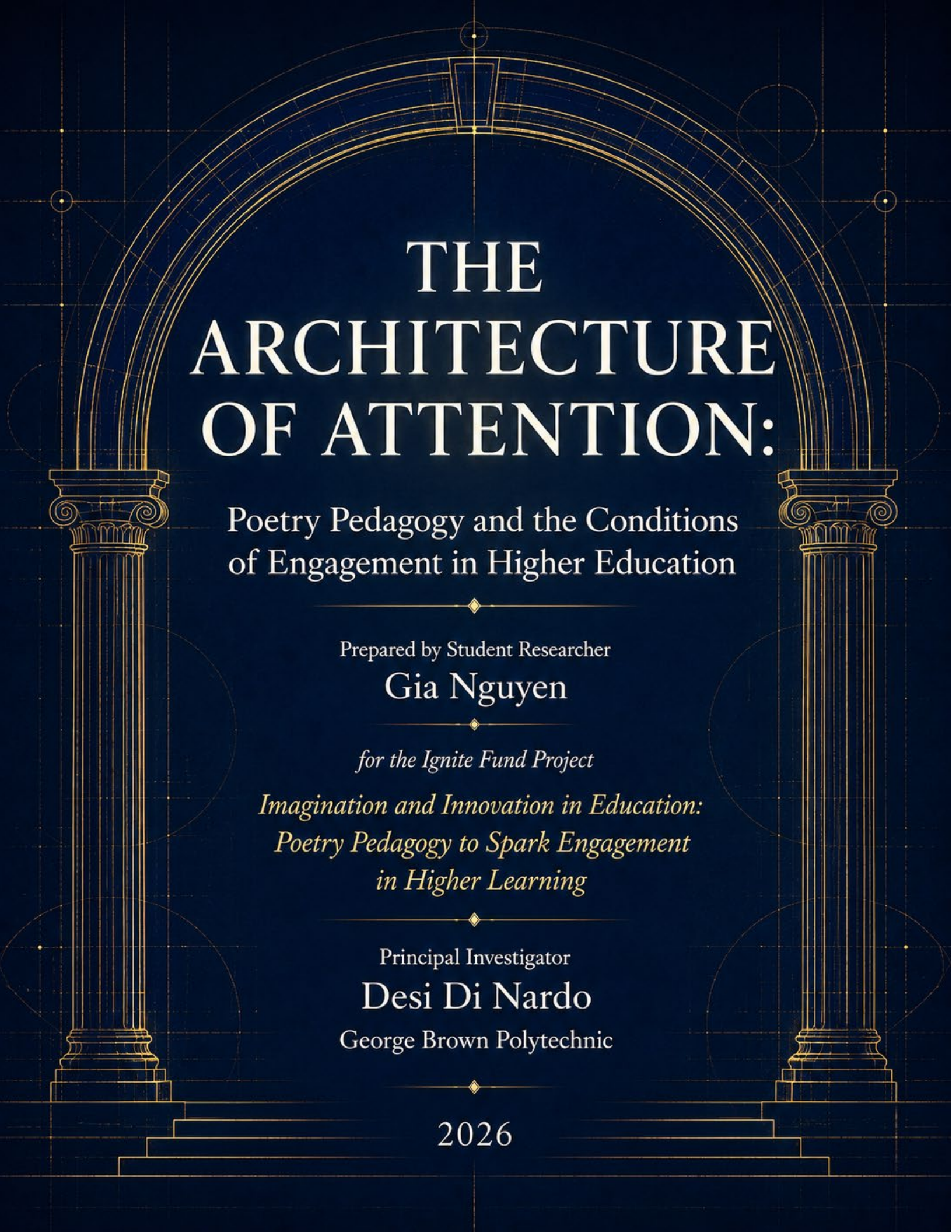




THE ARCHITECTURE OF ATTENTION:

Poetry Pedagogy and the Conditions
of Engagement in Higher Education

Prepared by Student Researcher

Gia Nguyen

for the Ignite Fund Project

*Imagination and Innovation in Education:
Poetry Pedagogy to Spark Engagement
in Higher Learning*

Principal Investigator

Desi Di Nardo

George Brown Polytechnic

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Conceptual Foundations: Imagination, Attention, and Pedagogical Encounter

Attention is not merely a cognitive resource; it is the precondition for encounter, the medium through which learning becomes possible. In higher education—where distraction has become ambient and intellectual presence increasingly scarce—the question is no longer whether students can be engaged, but what architectures make engagement enduring, ethical, and visible on the page. This review positions poetry pedagogy not as a classroom technique, but as an emerging interdisciplinary field whose methods carry implications for scholarly publication, institutional research, ethics based inquiry, and wider conversations about imagination, engagement, and innovation in higher education. Poetry pedagogy offers one such architecture: a mode of teaching that sharpens perception, slows interpretation, and invites students to dwell within language with deliberation, attentiveness, and care. When cultivated intentionally, it becomes a practice of attention capable of awakening curiosity, deepening social connection, amplifying student voice, and strengthening academic engagement and achievement across diverse learning contexts. In tracing these intersections, this review maps a broad interdisciplinary terrain to illuminate the theoretical, pedagogical, and ethical dimensions necessary for understanding poetry's role within contemporary learning environments.

INTRODUCTION: POETRY PEDAGOGY IN HIGHER EDUCATION

Imagination and innovation have become institutional keywords in contemporary higher education, circulating as remedies long before their pedagogical demands are made explicit. In classrooms shaped by fractured attention, uneven belonging, and the lingering effects of disrupted learning, “engagement” can no longer be treated as a soft aspiration. It's the condition that determines whether teaching becomes learning at all. Yet these terms are easily romanticized. Imagination gets flattened into whimsy. Innovation becomes novelty. Engagement becomes a mood.

Poetry pedagogy, at its strongest, refuses that softness. It emerges not merely as a creative exercise but as a framework for designing language, attention, and participation so that thinking becomes visible, revisable, and accountable. In this framing, poetic practice functions as more than literary content. It becomes a rigorous training space for academic communication, where meaning is shaped under constraint, where rhetorical decisions can be taught rather than assumed, and students learn to carry ideas with greater precision and control.